

CORPORATE STRUCTURE

These questions test whether the company is structurally prepared for growth.

1. Is your company currently registered under the structure that best suits your present business and future plans?
2. Is the current ownership/shareholding structure clearly documented and up to date?
3. Does every founder's agreed ownership percentage match the company's official records?
4. If there are multiple founders, is there a written agreement defining their respective roles and responsibilities?
5. If a founder leaves the business tomorrow, do you have a documented process for dealing with their ownership interest?
6. Are all shareholders, partners or LLP partners formally documented in the company's records?
7. Has the company formally documented who has authority to enter into major contracts or financial commitments?
8. Are all changes in ownership, directorship, partnership or capital properly recorded and documented?
9. Does the company maintain its statutory registers, resolutions and corporate records in an organised manner?
10. Are all major business assets held by the company or properly documented as belonging to the business?
11. If your business has subsidiaries, related entities or sister concerns, are the relationships between them properly documented?
12. If you have taken loans or investments from founders, are those transactions formally documented?
13. Are related-party transactions within the business properly documented and approved?
14. Could an investor or buyer understand your ownership structure by reviewing your current corporate documents without requiring significant clarification?
15. If your company raised investment tomorrow, could the existing corporate structure accommodate that investment without major restructuring?

GOVERNANCE

This should determine whether the business is actually being run through systems rather than informal founder decisions.

1. Is it clearly documented who can make financial, operational and strategic decisions for the company?
2. If there are two or more founders, do you have a defined process for resolving disagreements?
3. Are important decisions of the company formally recorded rather than relying only on WhatsApp, calls or verbal discussions?
4. Do you conduct and document formal board/partner/shareholder meetings where required?
5. Does the company have clearly defined approval limits for major expenses and commitments?
6. Can one person independently enter into a significant financial or contractual commitment on behalf of the company?
7. Are conflicts of interest involving founders, directors or senior employees identified and documented?
8. Do you have a documented process for approving related-party transactions?
9. Is there a clear process for handling complaints, disputes or serious internal issues?
10. Are key responsibilities of founders and senior management clearly assigned?
11. If the primary founder became unavailable for 60 days, could the business continue operating through an established decision-making structure?
12. Are important company documents accessible to the appropriate people without depending on one founder's personal laptop or email?
13. Do you maintain a central repository for corporate, financial, contractual and compliance documents?
14. Are major strategic decisions supported by written records, approvals or documentation?
15. If an investor asked how decisions are made within the company, could you demonstrate a functioning governance system rather than simply explaining it verbally?

CONTRACTS

This is one of the most commercially important sections for Veloria.

1. Does the company have a written agreement with every major client?
2. Does each client agreement clearly define exactly what the company is required to deliver?
3. Does your contract clearly define what is outside the agreed scope of work?
4. Do your agreements specify how additional work or scope changes will be charged?
5. Do your client contracts specify payment timelines and consequences of delayed payment?
6. Do you require an advance or milestone payment for significant projects?
7. Does your contract clearly state when and how either party can terminate the relationship?
8. Does the agreement specify what happens to unpaid amounts when a project is terminated?
9. Do your contracts contain a reasonable limitation of liability?
10. Do your contracts clearly establish who owns intellectual property created during the engagement?
11. Do you have written agreements with freelancers, consultants and external agencies working on your projects?
12. Do those agreements clearly transfer or license the relevant intellectual property to your company?
13. Are confidentiality obligations included in your agreements with clients, employees, consultants and vendors where appropriate?
14. Before signing a major contract, does someone with appropriate commercial/legal understanding review the agreement?
15. If your largest client stopped paying tomorrow, would your existing contract give you a clear contractual basis to recover the outstanding amount and enforce your rights?

COMPLIANCE

Keep these practical. The founder should be able to answer based on actual records.

1. Are all registrations and licences required for your current business activities currently valid?
2. Are your statutory filings being completed within the applicable timelines?
3. Are your tax registrations and filings up to date?
4. Are your company/LLP records updated whenever there is a material change in ownership, management or structure?
5. Do you maintain a calendar or system for tracking recurring compliance deadlines?
6. Have you received any regulatory, tax or statutory notice that remains unresolved?
7. Are your employees and consultants properly documented according to the nature of their engagement?
8. Are required employment policies and workplace documentation in place for your organisation?
9. If your business collects customer or employee personal data, do you have appropriate privacy/data-handling documentation and processes?
10. Do you obtain the necessary permissions or licences before using third-party content, photographs, music, software or intellectual property commercially?
11. Are your website terms, privacy documentation and other customer-facing legal documents appropriate for the way your business currently operates?
12. Are all significant regulatory or statutory communications stored centrally and tracked until closure?
13. Has your business undergone a formal compliance review within the last 12 months?
14. Do you have a person or professional responsible for monitoring changes in regulations relevant to your business?
15. If an investor asked for your company's compliance records tomorrow, could you produce the relevant documents in an organised manner?

TRANSACTION READINESS

This is where Veloria can differentiate itself from ordinary legal firms.

1. If you received an investment offer tomorrow, could you provide an investor with your complete corporate documents without significant preparation?
2. Do you have an organised folder containing all important legal, corporate and commercial documents?
3. Are your current shareholders/partners and ownership percentages accurately reflected in your records?
4. Are all founder and shareholder agreements properly documented?
5. Are all outstanding loans, founder advances and financial obligations documented?
6. Can you provide signed agreements for your company's major clients and vendors?
7. Can you demonstrate ownership of the intellectual property that is critical to your business?
8. Are all employees, consultants and freelancers who have created important IP bound by appropriate agreements?
9. Do you maintain a record of ongoing litigation, disputes, notices or potential claims against the company?
10. Are all material liabilities of the business properly identified and documented?
11. Can you identify all material contracts that would need to be reviewed during an investment or acquisition process?
12. If an investor requested a due-diligence data room tomorrow, could you populate it within a reasonable period?
13. Have you identified any unresolved legal or compliance issue that could affect a future investment or acquisition?
14. Have you reviewed whether your current contracts contain restrictions that could affect a future investment, acquisition or change in control?
15. If an investor began due diligence tomorrow, do you believe your business could withstand detailed scrutiny without major legal restructuring?

BUSINESS RISK

This section should make founders think. These are risk-identification questions, not theoretical legal questions.

1. What would happen to the business if your largest client stopped working with you tomorrow?
2. Does any single client currently contribute a disproportionately large percentage of your revenue?
3. If your primary founder became unavailable tomorrow, could the business continue operating normally?
4. Does the business depend heavily on one employee, consultant, supplier or technology provider?
5. Could a former employee or consultant leave with critical business information, client relationships or intellectual property?
6. Do you have any major verbal commitments with clients, vendors, founders or employees that are not documented in writing?
7. Are there any significant amounts owed to your business that have remained unpaid beyond the agreed payment period?
8. Does the business currently have any dispute, threatened claim, legal notice or regulatory issue that could materially affect operations?
9. Could a failure by one major supplier or service provider significantly disrupt your business?
10. Do you have appropriate insurance for the major risks associated with your business?
11. Does your business hold or process information whose loss or unauthorised disclosure could materially harm the company or its customers?
12. Could a third party claim ownership over any important intellectual property currently used by your business?
13. Are there any major business arrangements currently operating on trust or informal understandings rather than enforceable documentation?
14. Have you identified the three events that could cause the greatest financial damage to your business?
15. Do you have a documented response plan for at least the most serious operational, legal or reputational risk facing the company?

INVESTMENT READINESS

This is potentially the most important section for Veloria's "Build before you raise" positioning.

1. If an investor asked for your complete corporate documents tomorrow, could you provide them immediately?
2. Can you clearly explain your current ownership structure and how it will change after the proposed investment?
3. Have all previous investments, loans, founder contributions and convertible instruments been properly documented?
4. Do you have a clear record of all shareholders/investors and their respective rights?
5. Are there any informal promises of equity, profit share or ownership that have not been formally documented?
6. Have you documented the intellectual property that represents the core value of your business?
7. Can you demonstrate that the company—not individual founders or former employees—owns the critical IP used in the business?
8. Are your major customer and vendor contracts properly executed and available for due diligence?
9. Are there any significant contracts that could terminate or change if the company receives investment or undergoes a change in ownership?
10. Are all material litigation, disputes, notices and liabilities disclosed and documented internally?
11. Have you identified and resolved any outstanding corporate or regulatory compliance issues before approaching investors?
12. Do you maintain an organised legal and corporate data room or equivalent document repository?
13. Have you previously conducted a legal due-diligence exercise on your own company?
14. If an investor questioned any major claim in your pitch deck—revenue, ownership, IP, customers, contracts or market position—could you produce supporting documentation?
15. If a serious investor offered to begin due diligence next week, would you be confident that your business is legally and commercially ready for the process?